

How Trump's tariffs could tear up Turnberry

送信者: POLITICO Brussels Playbook 受信日時: 2026-07-27 13:55

【メール原文】

POLITICO's must-read briefing on what's driving the day in Brussels, by Gerardo Fortuna, Nicholas Vinocur and Gabriel Gavin. By GABRIEL GAVIN GOOD MOR

POLITICO's must-read briefing on what's driving the day in Brussels, by Gerardo Fortuna, Nicholas Vinocur and Gabriel Gavin.

By GABRIEL GAVIN

Send tips here | Follow us @gerardofortuna @NicholasVinocur @GabrielGavin | Listen to Playbook and view in your browser

GOOD MORNING — I'm Gabriel Gavin, wishing a very restful National Sleepy Head Day to those celebrating in Finland. The observance, which began in the Middle Ages, now sees celebrities thrown into the sea in the early hours of the morning. Herätys!

In today's Playbook:

- To federate or confederate? The language of a “Bosnian” solution for Cyprus.
- The Iceland referendum that could move the country closer to EU membership.
- Faces in the crowd: Kristrún Frostadóttir, Tanja Fajon, Friedrich Merz, Charles de Gaulle, Olof Gill, María Ángela Holguín, Brando Benifei, Guðrún Hafsteinsdóttir, Elke Van den Brandt, António Guterres, Dacian Cioloș, Bernd Lange, Bart De Wever and many more.

On today's Brussels Playbook Podcast: Zoya and Kathryn hash out what's at stake in Iceland's EU referendum.

DRIVING THE DAY

TURNBERRY ON THE ROCKS: Senior lawmakers are warning the EU-U.S. trade deal could implode if Donald Trump follows through on his latest tariff threat — exactly one year after the pact was struck in Turnberry, Scotland.

The U.S. president on Friday threatened a “substantial” new tariff on the EU and pledged a trade investigation after the EU fined Google €890 million for breaching the bloc's rules on large tech platforms.

Trigger point: Trump's threatened retaliation would violate the terms of the deal reached last summer, center-left lawmaker Brando Benifei told Playbook. “We must be clear: If there is going to be any retaliatory tariff in response to the application of our digital legislation, the suspension clauses will need to be activated,” said Benifei, who chairs the European Parliament's delegation to the U.S.

How it works: The Turnberry pact caps U.S. tariffs on most European exports at 15 percent. In return, the EU offers duty-free entry for U.S. industrial goods and for some agricultural and seafood products. The deal's safeguards allow the Commission to suspend some of that preferential treatment.

PRAYING FOR TACO: Bernd Lange, chair of the Parliament's Committee on International Trade, warned that fresh duties would cause the agreement to "collapse" — but is holding out hope that Trump will back down. "We have already seen several posts on Truth Social that did not lead to concrete actions," he said. "I hope that will also be the case this time."

A delicate deal: The agreement calmed months of transatlantic trade tensions. But its safeguards were always a flashpoint. Before the Parliament approved legislation implementing the EU's side last month, Benifei's Socialists and Democrats pushed for stronger suspension clauses and insisted Washington fully uphold its commitments before it would give its backing.

It was going so well ... An American Chamber of Commerce survey published this morning — and conducted before Trump's latest threat — found U.S. businesses have become less pessimistic about transatlantic relations . The proportion expecting ties to worsen fell from 46 percent in September to 28 percent. Respondents ranked "non-tariff practices and unfair competition" as the top issue the two sides should tackle.

No rest: The Commission is now trying to prevent the dispute from escalating. "There will be technical-level contact during the week," Commission Deputy Chief Spokesperson Olof Gill told Camille Gijs on Sunday.

Holiday homework: EU ambassadors — most of whom are on leave — weren't called in for crisis talks over the weekend. But they may be required to dial in to coordinate a response if Trump follows through.

READ MORE: How does the EU come up with its hefty bills for tech companies? Sam Clark, Pieter Haeck, Ellen O'Regan and Jacob Parry have everything you need to know .

BIG AND BREAKING

BERLIN PRIDE SUSPECT KILLED: Abdul Ballout, the man believed to have carried out the Berlin Pride attack that killed one person and injured 29 others Saturday, was shot dead by German police in a confrontation yesterday, the AP reports .

AIR INCURSIONS: Romania's President Nicușor Dan has accused Moscow of "inadmissible and intolerable" violations of NATO and EU airspace after Romanian fighter jets shot down three suspected Russian drones in as many days. Reuters has the story .

EUROPE BATTLES WILDFIRES: The massive fires that have forced the evacuation of more than 100,000 people in Spain have reignited a political clash in the country. In France, President Emmanuel Macron will hold a crisis meeting of his Cabinet in response to wildfires that are now closing in on Bordeaux.

IRAN SLAMS UKRAINE'S "HOSTILE" ACT: Iran summoned a Ukrainian diplomat in Tehran after an attack on an Iranian commercial vessel in the Caspian Sea, CNBC reports .

KAZAKH CALL TO END WAR: The Ukraine war should be "frozen," Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev told Russian President Vladimir Putin Saturday. Le Monde reports the rare rebuke from the Moscow ally was made during a meeting between the two leaders.

FAILED SAHEL BID: Slovenia's new government has filed a criminal complaint against former Foreign Minister Tanja Fajon over her bid to become the EU's special representative for the Sahel, local media report . Fajon's nomination was withdrawn, with Denmark's Birgitte Nygaard Markussen appointed last week . Fajon said in a Facebook post last night her candidacy was "conducted legally and professionally."

EU ON ICE

ICELAND VOTES: Early voting begins today in a historic referendum that will allow Icelanders to decide whether to relaunch talks to join the EU. The first ballots will be cast ahead of the Aug. 29 referendum, Sebastian Starcevic writes.

Frozen talks: The Arctic island of about 400,000 people, which is already part of the Schengen Area, began negotiations with Brussels in 2010 amid a financial crisis. It suspended talks in 2013 after its economy quickly rebounded, amid a bitter dispute with the EU over fishing rights.

Trump effect: But the debate erupted again after Trump threatened to invade Greenland (which he repeatedly referred to as "Iceland" in a speech at the World Economic Forum earlier this year), prompting Reykjavík to reconsider its alliances.

Referendum of the Valkyries: Icelandic Prime Minister Kristrún Frostadóttir and her Valkyrie coalition (the Norse mythology reference is because all three parties are headed by women) announced the referendum earlier this year in what she said was a bid to settle "a debate that has hung over the Icelandic nation."

The question Icelanders will answer: "Should Iceland resume accession negotiations with the European Union?" The options are simple: Já or Nei.

Icelanders are split 50-50 on whether to restart the talks, according to opinion polls. "We are divided in nearly equal groups," Guðrún Hafsteinsdóttir, chair of Iceland's largest opposition party, told Playbook in a phone interview from Vatnajökull, Iceland's largest glacier. "The referendum will be very tight."

Reminder: Even if Icelanders vote yes, there's still some way to go before the country joins the EU. Reykjavík would need to complete accession negotiations first, which it could do at a lightning pace due to its integration with the EU, before heading to another referendum on membership.

20-SECOND PLAYBOOK PRIMER

Is the shop closed for the summer yet? For the Council — almost. With today's meeting of economy and finance chiefs now canceled , EU fisheries ministers have the final engagement before the break, heading to Cork on Tuesday and Wednesday. After that, the Council goes quiet until Aug. 31, when defense ministers reconvene in Ireland — Wicklow, to be precise — to get the machinery turning again.

TALK TO PLAYBOOK: On the Brussels Playbook Podcast, Zoya asked who or what you'd want to see on the new euro banknotes. WhatsApp us on +32 491 050629 and listen from 7 a.m. to hear if we give you a shoutout.

EYES ON NICOSIA

CYPRUS PEACE PUSH: António Guterres will arrive in Cyprus today for the first visit by a United Nations secretary-general in 16 years. His mission: to restart talks over the division of the island. Guterres' term ends in December, making this a last-ditch effort toward a lasting settlement before he leaves, my colleague Nektaria Stamouli writes in.

New plan: A controversial new proposal drafted by Guterres' Personal Envoy on Cyprus María Ángela Holguín, suggests a loose Bosnian-style structure with federal power-sharing. That would allow Greek Cypriots to call it a federation and Turkish Cypriots to call it a confederation. The island has been divided since Turkish forces invaded in 1974.

A role for Brussels: The EU says it remains committed to supporting U.N.-led efforts to achieve a comprehensive settlement of the Cyprus issue. Earlier this month, the Commission designated Executive Vice President Raffaele Fitto as its special representative for Cyprus. But even a visit from to the island by EU defense ministers turned into a tense standoff with Turkey .

4 MORE THINGS GETTING US TALKING

GENERAL INTEREST: French politicians of all political stripes are uniting behind one man : Charles De Gaulle.

BEST OF FRIENDS? France and Germany could put aside their differences to strike an agreement on their lucrative automobile sectors and preferential treatment for EU industries.

CALLING ON KIM: Russia is seeking an additional 30,000 troops from North Korea to fight its war in Ukraine, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned .

CITY TAX FEARS: Britain's bankers are afraid new Prime Minister Andy Burnham could be about to hit them with a massive tax bill to fill the U.K.'s government coffers.

CORE UNDER PRESSURE

EXCLUSIVE — TAX RETREAT: The European Commission is considering watering down a controversial levy on large businesses designed to raise money for the EU's next seven-year budget, four EU officials with knowledge of the discussions told Gregorio Sorigi and Hans von der Burchard.

What is it? The Corporate Resource for Europe, or CORE, would impose an extra 0.1 percent charge on companies operating in the EU that have a net turnover above €100 million, raising an estimated €6.8 billion a year. Companies with a higher turnover would pay a bigger annual lump sum.

Why it's needed: The EU is searching for new revenue to cover mounting defense and competitiveness spending, as well as repayments on its post-pandemic debt, without relying entirely on higher contributions from national governments.

A tough sell: The proposal faces opposition from business groups, the center-right European People's Party and, crucially, the EU capitals that must unanimously approve any new EU taxes. Critics say taxing turnover rather than profits would hit companies regardless of their margins and undermine the EU's push to boost competitiveness.

The compromise: Officials are considering exempting loss-making companies and raising the revenue threshold to exclude smaller businesses, according to the officials, who were granted anonymity to discuss the sensitive plans. The Commission argues that companies benefiting from the single market should contribute — and that a 0.1 percent charge is modest.

Testing the waters: Irish EU Ambassador Aingel O'Donoghue, who is steering talks under Ireland's Council presidency, has been canvassing capitals on CORE and seven other proposed levies. Their feedback will shape possible changes, with the Commission expected to update its revenue estimates in the autumn.

BRUSSELS CORNER

WEATHER: Partly cloudy. High 23C

SIGNS OF LIFE IN DESERTED BRUSSELS: Commissioners, diplomats and EU officials have decamped for the summer, with barely anyone left in the EU district. That's bad news for those venturing out among the tumbleweeds on Rue de la Loi and the Schuman area. But don't worry: you've still got options.

Kamilou, on Rue Joseph II, is staying open. So are the La Galia brasserie in Rue Jacques de Lalaing, Léopold Café Arts-Loi and Bon, on Rue de Trèves.

Art's & Bagels, also in Rue de Trèves, is staying open all summer, except for public holidays.

The l'Expresso sandwich shop in Rue Joseph II is still open through Wednesday, but will be closed for three weeks from Thursday.

To Meli on Square Frère-Orban is still open this week but closes from Aug. 8. Its Schuman establishment is closing from Aug. 10.

Forget about these: Greek food hub Attica is already closed for the summer; so is Japanese coffee and sandwich place SŪN.

SECOND CAR-FREE SUNDAY INCOMING: On Sept. 20, Brussels is again turning into the largest car-free zone of Europe — for a day. But as of next year, Brussels is set to get a second day without traffic, Hanne Cokelaere reports.

No carbon copy: The second car-free day would happen on May 2, according to a Le Soir report, confirmed by POLITICO. But "it won't be a copy-paste" of the car-free day in September, Brussels-Capital Region Mobility Minister Elke Van den Brandt said in a statement. Instead, it would be pitched as an "open-doors" day, with local businesses given more space for things like extra-large terraces, banquets or workshops.

No pressure: "A second day per year isn't an activist demand, it's a response to a concrete popular request," Van den Brandt said.

TBC: Mayors of Brussels' municipalities still have to green light the plan but are expected to back it, provided they get the necessary resources. Van den Brandt said the government is "working to cover the organizational costs."

TOP OF THE PLAYBOOKS

Berlin: Friedrich Merz will try to repair the damage inside his own party after a botched attempt to replace his transport minister.

London: Andy Burnham will host Volodymyr Zelenskyy at a naval base today to illustrate Britain's ongoing support for Ukraine.

Paris: France's Interior Minister Laurent Nuñez has been forced to defend his government's record on managing wildfires that have ravaged 115,000 hectares since the start of the season.

Washington: Republicans had months to torpedo Graham Platner, the Democrats' former Senate candidate in Maine. They now have exactly 100 days to sink his replacement .

AGENDA

— Agriculture Commissioner Christophe Hansen attends the Foire de Libramont and meets Belgian PM Bart De Wever and Belgian Agriculture Minister David Clarinval.

— Signature of the new Protocol implementing the Sustainable Fisheries Partnership Agreement between the EU and Seychelles, with Fisheries Commissioner Costas Kadis receiving his counterpart from the Seychelles, Wallace Cosgrow, at 10 a.m. Watch .

— German Chancellor Friedrich Merz receives Icelandic PM Kristján Þór Guðnason.

BIRTHDAYS

Dacian Cioloș, a former MEP, Romanian PM and European commissioner; MEPs Cristina Maestre, Tamás Deutsch and Sergio Berlato; former MEP Yannick Jadot; writer Alexandra Stenbock-Fermor; European Parliament's Anne-Cécile Gault; VELUX's Elisabeth Hoffmann; Asian Development Bank's James Correia; Transport Community's Matej Zakonjšek; Newstalk's Joe Lynam.

Playbook is brought to you by POLITICO's EU Politics team: Gerardo Fortuna, Nicholas Vinocur, Gabriel Gavin, Zoya Sheftalovich, Max Griera, Mari Eccles, Hanne Cokelaere and Sebastian Starcevic. And: reporters Ferdinand Knapp and Milena Wälde, editors Alex Spence and James Panichi, and producers Dean Southwell and Hugh Kapernaros.

SUBSCRIBE to the POLITICO newsletter family: Brussels Playbook | London Playbook | London Playbook PM | Playbook Paris | Berlin Playbook | Sunday Crunch | EU Influence | London Influence | D.C. Playbook | D.C. Influence | Canada Playbook | POLITICO Forecast | All our POLITICO Pro policy morning newsletters

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp

[Update your preferences](#) | [Unsubscribe from this email](#) | [Unsubscribe from all emails](#)

POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium